The Price of Prestige

INITIAL DESIGN & 12-HOUR BUILD PLAN

Group 15 | Kazi Boni Amin, Krrish Setia, Andy Wang

Status: Proposed adaptation for team review, prepared before Twine implementation. This is a working design, not the final submission. Keep the original story outline as an earlier draft.

ACM case study identified

Abusive Workplace Behavior - Association for Computing Machinery

1. Scenario description

You play as Diane, a new graduate joining a prestigious augmented reality research team. Max, its celebrated technical lead, reacts to mistakes with humiliation, while research manager Jean protects him. Before an important demonstration, Diane discovers a defect and must decide how to obtain a reliable fix without abandoning coworker Eli. When research credit is threatened, Diane must weigh her career, Eli's wishes, and the possibility of reporting to HR adviser Priya. The story follows the costs and limits of documenting, supporting, reporting, staying, and leaving.

2. Characters

Character	Role, motivation, and interaction
Diane - player	New graduate seeking professional growth and financial stability. Chooses how to respond to mistreatment, technical risk, and unfair credit.
Max - technical lead	Acclaimed AR researcher focused on deadlines and prestige. Berates colleagues and uses research credit as leverage. Expertise does not excuse his conduct.
Jean - research manager	Protects Max because she fears losing funding and technical leadership. Directly dismisses Diane's concerns. Use Jean throughout; remove the inconsistent name Ada.
Eli - coworker	Wants a reliable product and fair treatment but fears retaliation. Reviews the defect, explains his concerns, and decides what account he is willing to provide.
Priya - HR adviser	Explains this fictional company's reporting options and gathers accounts. Offers interim support; cannot promise a finding or a particular punishment.

Original extension

Diane, Max, Jean, the AR setting, abuse, and punitive credit removal come from the source case. Eli, Priya, the evidence and consent choices, the reporting process, and the five differentiated outcomes are proposed additions. Rewrite all dialogue in the team's own words.

Choices, reasons, and learning

3. Ethical dilemmas

A. Speaking up versus immediate self-protection. Tell Jean in the hope she intervenes; preserve a factual account to support later action; or remain quiet for now because Diane fears losing the opportunity. These choices change the information and support available later, even when the plot reaches the same milestone.

B. Reliable work versus fear of blame. Ask Eli to review and test a correction, accepting a possible delay; attempt a rushed repair alone to avoid exposing him; or raise the defect openly so the team sees the risk. A technical error can require correction without justifying humiliation. Max remains responsible for his own abusive response.

C. Fair credit versus short-term career security. Challenge removal of earned credit with contribution records; talk with Eli before sharing his private account; or accept the decision to protect the immediate job. Supporting Eli must respect his choices. Diane can still report what she personally experienced or witnessed.

D. Accountability versus uncertain personal and team costs. Make a factual complaint to Priya; request a transfer or leave; remain while building safer peer practices; or continue without challenging leadership. Each route preserves something and leaves something unresolved. Neither staying nor leaving automatically makes Diane morally responsible for Max's conduct.

4. Lesson goals

1. Distinguish constructive criticism from abuse, including when the supervisor is technically respected.
2. Compare self-protection, coworker support, and escalation while considering uncertainty and another person's agency.
3. Explain why technical mistakes do not justify removing earned research credit.
4. Recognize how management and review practices affect both working conditions and software quality.

ACM connections for the ending reflections

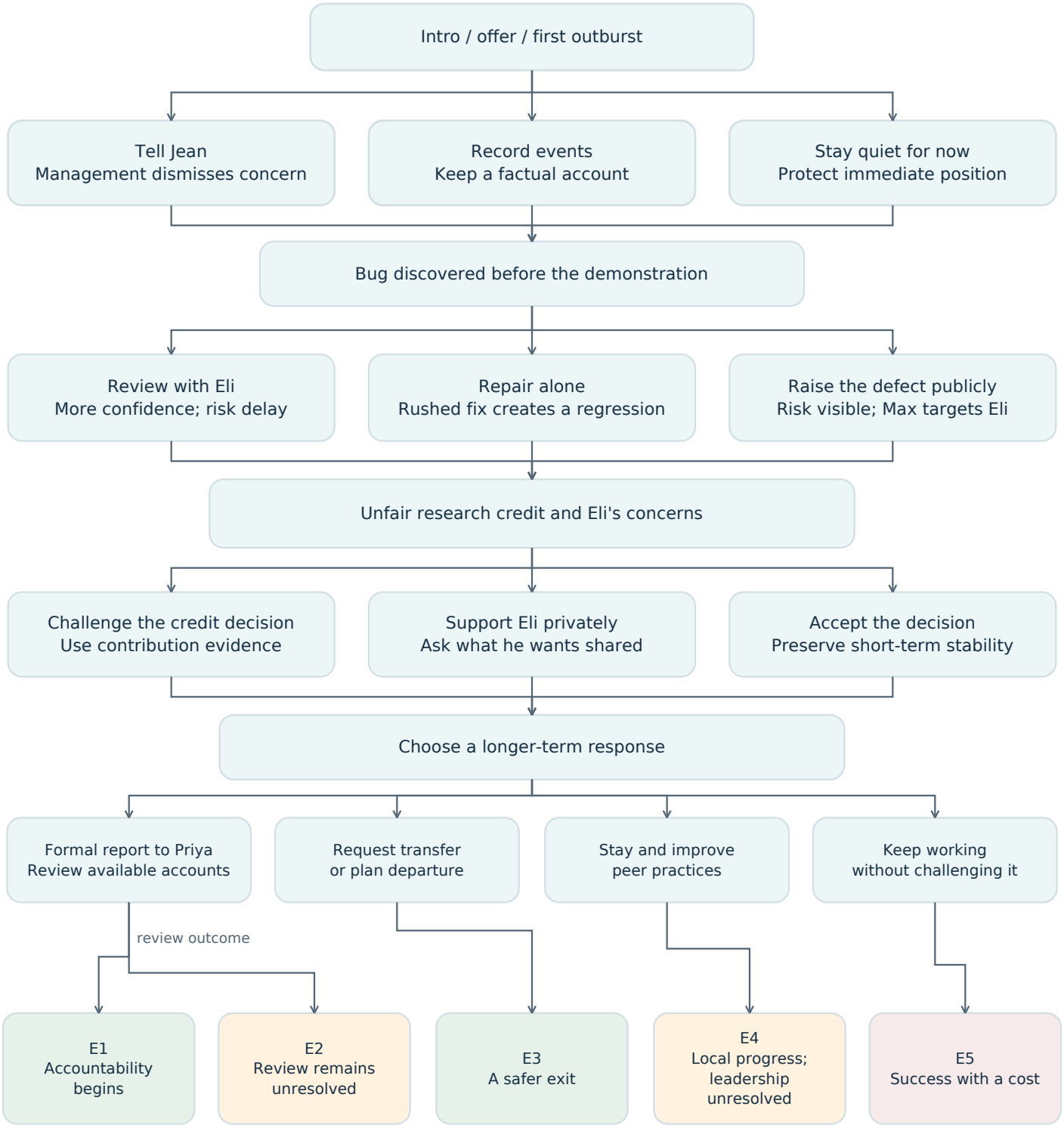
Principle	Application in this adaptation
1.2 / 1.4	Reduce harm; address bullying, retaliation, and unfair treatment.
1.5	Recognize people's actual research and code contributions.
2.4 / 2.6	Seek constructive review and help when a task exceeds current competence.
3.3 / 3.4	Hold leaders responsible for working conditions and effective ethical processes.

Implementation target

Approximately 22-26 passages, four major decision stages, and five endings. Use Harlowe. Preserve relevant earlier choices in later dialogue: whether Diane documented events, how the defect was handled, and whether Eli agreed to contribute his account. These are narrative facts, not a moral score.

5. Proposed branching flow

A design sketch before implementation. Boxes may expand into several passages. Arrows show intended routes; shared milestones must retain the consequences of earlier choices.



Annotation A: The complaint route has two possible outcomes based on available information and corroboration, not a guaranteed victory. Annotation B: Every ending will have a short ACM reflection and a restart option. Final version: Add a separate diagram from the implemented passage links and annotate actual changes.

Outcomes and team record

Five planned endings

Ending	Concrete outcome and remaining tension
E1 - Accountability begins	A corroborated complaint leads to an independent review, corrected credit, and an experienced interim supervisor. The milestone is delayed, and trust takes time to rebuild.
E2 - Review unresolved	Some allegations remain unsettled. Priya arranges interim support or a transfer while review continues. An unresolved finding does not establish that Diane's experience was false.
E3 - A safer exit	Diane transfers or leaves, with the option of providing a factual account. She protects her well-being but loses a prestigious opportunity; the team's wider problems remain.
E4 - Local progress	Coworkers adopt peer review and support each other. Immediate risks improve, but Jean's protection of Max and the leadership problem remain unresolved.
E5 - Success with a cost	The demonstration succeeds, but unfair credit and fear continue. Show a specific consequence for Diane or Eli instead of labelling the player bad.

6. Team contributions

Roles already supplied: Krrish Setia: main writer. Andy Wang: editor and secondary writer. Kazi Boni Amin: programmer and art designer. The table below is deliberately unfinished: enter actual, team-agreed percentages after the work is complete. Every row must total 100%.

Section	Kazi	Krrish	Andy	Total
Scenario description	Confirm	Confirm	Confirm	100%
Characters	Confirm	Confirm	Confirm	100%
Ethical dilemmas	Confirm	Confirm	Confirm	100%
Lesson goals	Confirm	Confirm	Confirm	100%
Story flow	Confirm	Confirm	Confirm	100%

Also record which perspective each person actually developed, with a concrete example or passage. Suggested division for remaining work: Krrish - Diane's career pressure and dialogue; Andy - Eli's concerns, management reasoning, and editing; Kazi - consequences across branches, implementation, diagrams, and visual design. These are proposed assignments, not claims of completed work.

Changes from the supplied outline

Remove the guaranteed lawsuit payout, instant promotion to Max's role, and team collapse caused by declining a promotion. Keep one consistent manager name and title. Replace generic endings with distinct outcomes and explanations. Preserve the original outline and this proposed flow so the final document can show the real design process.

Build schedule and verification

Aim to finish the deliverables in 10 hours and keep the final 2 hours for unexpected problems. Times below are elapsed work time, not clock appointments.

Elapsed time	Phase	Completion checkpoint
0:00-0:45	1. Initial design	Review and retain this draft; settle names, choices, and proposed flow.
0:45-1:15	2. Twine setup	Create the story in Harlowe; add intro and first choice.
1:15-4:15	3. Complete the story	Every route has content and reaches an ending; earlier choices affect later text.
4:15-5:15	4. Visual design	Apply one custom stylesheet; check intro, choice, and ending layouts.
5:15-7:15	5. Final design PDF	Match actual story; add final annotated flow and agreed contributions.
7:15-9:15	6. Testing and editing	Exercise every choice and ending; inspect downloaded HTML; proofread.
9:15-10:00	7. Package submission	Verify HTML/assets and PDF; open the exact files intended for upload.
10:00-12:00	8. Reserve	Resolve remaining defects and submission problems.

Rubric checklist

Intro: story name, ACM case-study link, and all member names and roles.
Grammar (2): proofread every passage, choice, and ending.
Playability (3): filled passages, working links, obvious choices, usable restart.
Originality (2): original interactions and consequences extend the ACM premise.
Realistic choices (3): credible incentives and uncertain institutional outcomes.
Multiple perspectives (5): decisions affect people, dialogue, information, or endings.
Consistent implementation (5): abuse, fair credit, and management responsibility remain central.
Visual appeal (5): custom layout, typography, colors, and readable choice controls.

The supplied rubric explicitly totals the Twine story at 25 points. It does not include the design-document scoring details; use the required sections without relying on the older feedback's unverified subsection point values.

Final checks

Keep the design and playable story consistent. Check every choice, not only every ending. Test the exported HTML independently of Twine. If media is added, include it and test it from the submission folder. The final contribution table must contain actual percentages. A bare unannotated map is not the planned design-document deliverable.

Official references

ACM: Abusive Workplace Behavior
ACM Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct
Twine browser editor
Official Twine reference guide